

Hotels & Travel DPDPA Starter Checklist

Your hotel or travel business doesn't just manage bookings — it collects, shares and stores guest travel data every day. Work through these ten areas to bring guest IDs, passport handling, OTA sharing, system access and old-record retention under DPDPA-ready control.

Guest IDs

Passport Copies

OTA Sharing

Travel Documents

WhatsApp Confirmations

CCTV

PMS Access

Old Guest Records

How to use this: tick what you already do, and turn the unticked boxes into your next actions. Start with ID/passport handling, OTA/vendor sharing and PMS access — they remove the most risk for the least effort.

1 Guest & traveller data inventory

- ☐ List where guest and traveller data is collected — front desk, booking desk, website, OTAs, WhatsApp, agents.
- ☐ Record what each guest record holds, why, and who can access it.
- ☐ Collect only the data the booking or trip actually needs.
- ☐ Keep one primary PMS/CRM record so you always know what you hold.
- ☐ Explain data use and sharing at booking or check-in.

2 Aadhaar / passport / visa documents

- ☐ Collect Aadhaar, passport and visa copies only when the stay or trip needs them.
- ☐ Prefer a secure booking portal or upload link over WhatsApp and email.
- ☐ Don't keep duplicate ID copies on staff phones or personal accounts.
- ☐ Restrict who can open and forward passport and visa documents.
- ☐ Delete ID and travel documents once the stay or trip is complete.

3 WhatsApp & email document sharing

- ☐ Reduce passport, ID and ticket exchange over WhatsApp and email.
- ☐ Verify the recipient's number or address before sending any document.
- ☐ Don't forward guest IDs into staff or vendor WhatsApp groups.
- ☐ Clear documents from chats once moved into your PMS/records.
- ☐ Use business channels, not staff personal accounts, for guest documents.

4 OTA & booking-engine data

- ☐ Know what guest data each OTA and booking engine collects and stores.
- ☐ Download only the guest data you need for service, not for unrelated marketing.
- ☐ Apply a retention rule to data pulled from OTA dashboards.
- ☐ Restrict who in your team can access OTA and booking-engine dashboards.
- ☐ Confirm OTA and channel-manager sharing terms for guest data.

5 PMS / CRM / front-desk access

- ☐ Consolidate guest records into a PMS/CRM with role-based access.
- ☐ Limit which staff can view full guest records and ID copies.
- ☐ Turn on MFA on PMS, email, cloud and OTA accounts.
- ☐ Remove ex-staff and old vendor/agent access the same day they leave.
- ☐ Review who can access guest data at least twice a year.

6 Travel agent & vendor sharing

- ☐ Share the minimum guest detail needed with transport vendors, guides and partners.
- ☐ Keep a simple register of which vendors receive guest data and why.
- ☐ Avoid forwarding full IDs where only contact or booking details are needed.
- ☐ Confirm what each vendor stores and for how long.
- ☐ Brief field staff and agents on what can and can't be shared.

7 Foreign guest / C-Form data

- ☐ Handle foreign guest and C-Form data through a defined, controlled process.
- ☐ Avoid moving passport and visa copies through WhatsApp or open inboxes.
- ☐ Share foreign guest data only with the authorities and parties that require it.
- ☐ Store C-Form-related records with access control, not reception folders.
- ☐ Apply a clear retention and deletion rule to foreign guest records.

8 CCTV, key-card & Wi-Fi logs

- ☐ Document the purpose for CCTV, key-card and Wi-Fi logging.
- ☐ Limit who can view CCTV footage and access logs.
- ☐ Place clear notices where CCTV and monitoring are in use.
- ☐ Set a retention period for CCTV footage and access logs.
- ☐ Review monitoring coverage so it doesn't collect more than needed.

9 Loyalty & promotional messaging

- ☐ Get clear opt-in before sending promotional or loyalty messages to guests.
- ☐ Offer an easy unsubscribe and honour preferences.
- ☐ Don't reuse OTA or booking data for marketing without a lawful basis.
- ☐ Keep a record of consent and message preferences.
- ☐ Separate transactional confirmations from promotional messaging.

10 Guest ID, passport & booking retention

- ☐ Set a retention period for guest IDs, passport copies, bookings and travel documents.
- ☐ Don't keep old guest records indefinitely for repeat-booking convenience.
- ☐ Schedule a periodic review to archive or delete records past their period.
- ☐ Offer guests a way to request deletion or correction of old data.
- ☐ Write a one-page plan for a wrong-recipient share or an exposed passport folder.